

Vital Substances & Eight Principles

Week 1 Complete Study Guide — slides, lecture transcripts,
Maciocia FCM 3rd ed. & Cheng Xinnong CAM 4th ed. synthesized

精

Jīng

Essence · Wax & Wick

氣

Qì

Vital Force · The Flame

血

Xuè

Blood · The River

津

Jīn Yè

Fluids · The Rain

神

Shén

Spirit · The Light

The Candle — Prof. Schrier's Core Teaching

Jīng 精 = wax & wick → the raw foundation, determines your lifespan, most dense. **Qì** 氣 = the flame → energy in action; without the candle you cannot have the flame. **Shén** 神 = the light cast → illumination & purpose; most immaterial; cannot be sustained without both Jīng & Qì. Once the candle is spent, the flame dies — this is death.

"The fabric of the universe, the element of life which is transformed and put into motion by Qì." — Rochat de la Vallée

Three Types of Jīng

Type	Source	Nature	Clinical Significance
Pre-Heaven Essence 先天精	Blending of sexual energies of mother & father <i>before</i> birth	Fixed in qty & quality — cannot be replenished. Stored in Kidneys.	Nourishes embryo/fetus; determines constitutional makeup, strength & vitality. Goal: preserve via rest, good diet, moderate exercise.
Post-Heaven Essence 後天精	Refined substances of Food & Fluids after birth (Stomach & Spleen)	Can be stored & replenished. Influenced by diet, herbs, breathing, exercise.	Continuously tops up Kidney Essence — your income topping up a fixed inheritance.
Kidney Essence 腎精	Composite of Pre-Heaven + Post-Heaven Essence	Fixed in qty; replenished by Post-Heaven. Resides at Míng Mén 命門.	Generates Tiān Guǐ — menses (♀) & sperm (♂). Produces Marrow → Spinal Cord → Brain.

5 Functions of Jīng

#	Function	Detail
1	Growth, Reproduction & Development	Sū Wèn Ch.1 — cycles of 7 (♀) & 8 (♂). Every 7/8 years a new phase of life governed by Jīng.
2	Basis of Kidney Qì	Kidney Yīn, Kidney Yáng, and Kidney Essence all derive from it
3	Produces Marrow	Fills Spinal Cord → Brain. Not Western bone marrow — a shared matrix of bone marrow, brain & spinal cord.
4	Basis of Constitutional Strength	Determines resistance to pathogenic factors; Wèi Qì also draws strength from Kidney Essence.
5	Basis of the Three Treasures	Jīng, Qì, and Shén all depend on Essence as their root foundation.

Sū Wèn Ch.1 — Developmental Cycles of 7 & 8

Age	Female (× 7)	Male (× 8)
7 / 8	Kidney Qì flourishes; teeth change; hair grows	Kidney Qì flourishes; teeth change; hair grows
14 / 16	Tiān Guǐ arrives; Chōng & Rèn flow; menstruation begins; can conceive	Tiān Guǐ arrives; Kidney Qì full; can father children
21 / 24	Kidney Qì balanced; wisdom teeth; full height	Kidney Qì even; muscles strong; wisdom teeth; full height
28 / 32	Sinews & bones strong; hair at full length; peak fertility	Peak condition — sinews & muscles most robust
35 / 40	Yáng Míng channels weaken; face begins to wither; hair starts falling	Kidney Qì declines; hair loosens; teeth begin to deteriorate
42 / 48	Three Yáng channels decline; face withers; hair turns white	Yáng Qì exhausted above; face withers; hair & temples turn white
49 / 56	Tiān Guǐ exhausted; Rèn empty; Tàì Chōng declines; menopause	Liver Qì declines; sinews cannot move freely; Tiān Guǐ exhausted
— / 64	—	Teeth and hair gone; essence and Qì exhausted

Jīng Deficiency — Clinical Signs

In Children

- Poor bone development; soft bones
- Late closure of fontanelle
- Mental dullness or retardation
- Developmental delays; late walking/talking

In Adults

- Softening of bones; weak knees & legs; lower backache; loose teeth
- Poor memory; absent-mindedness; decreased mental sharpness
- Tinnitus; deafness; premature greying
- Infertility / sterility; weakness of sexual activity

Foods for Jīng Deficiency

Almonds Bone Marrow Chicken Egg Kidney (organ) Liver (organ) Mussels Oysters Pollen Sesame Seed Walnuts

What is Qì? (6 Contextual Meanings)

1) Vitality, Energy, Gas, Air, Vapor · 2) Vital Breath · 3) Soul, Creative Force, Inspiration · 4) Aura · 5) Environmental forces — Liù Qì 六氣: Wind, Cold, Summer-Heat, Dryness, Fire, Dampness · 6) Nature/Temperature — Sì Qì 四氣: Hot, Warm, Cool, Cold

3 Meanings of Qì in EAM Context (Slide 11)

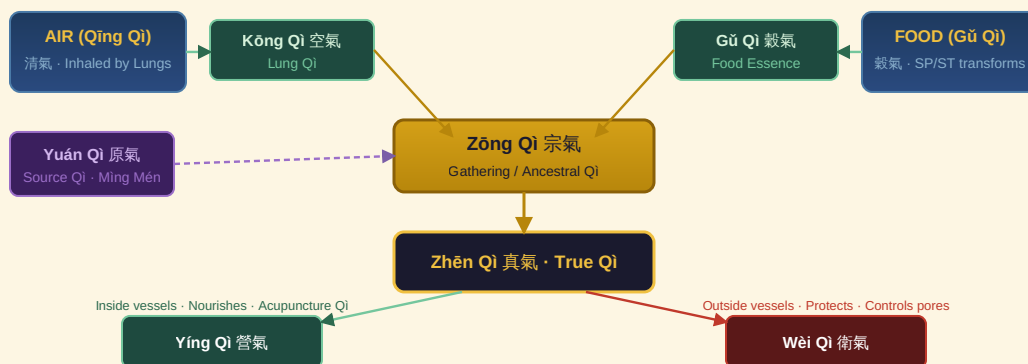
- **Qì of Chinese Medicine** — The quality of an action or function (e.g., "Liver Qì" = the Liver's functional energy)
- **Qì of the Channels** — Extension of consciousness through the body; associated with the Three Treasures (Jīng, Qì, Shén); channel Qì
- **Qì of Standing/Martial Arts** — The reaction to sinking and changing the body (cultivated Qì)

Key Definitions — Congenital & Acquired Qì (Slides 13–14)

- **Congenital Qì (先天氣)** — Inherited from parents; gathered and formed at conception; stored in the Kidneys; determines basic constitution, strength, vitality; essential to growth and development; **can be conserved but not replenished**; composite of Jīng Qì 精氣 (Essence) and Yuán Qì 原氣 (Source Qì)
- **Acquired Qì (後天氣)** — Post-natal Qì; can be stored and replenished; made from Gǔ Qì (food) + Air Qì + Zōng Qì (Gathering Qì)
- **Zhèng Qì 正氣 / Upright-Righteous Qì** — Wèi Qì + Yíng Qì + Kidney Essence; defends body from invasion by external pathogens; the opposite of evil/pathogenic Qì (Xié Qì 邪氣)

Qì Formation Flow

How Acquired Qì Is Made — AIR + FOOD → Zhēn Qì → Yíng & Wèi



All Types of Qì — Master Reference				
Name	漢字	Source	Location	Key Functions
Congenital Qì	先天氣	Inherited from parents; formed at conception	Kidneys	Determines constitution; cannot be replenished; composite of Jīng Qì & Yuán Qì
Air / Clear Qì	清氣	Inhaled by Lungs	Lungs	Inhalation and respiration
Food / Grain Qì	穀氣	Food → ST "rots & ripens" → SP transforms	Spleen / Stomach	Origin of Qì & Blood; rises to chest to combine with Air Qì; Heart transforms into Blood
Gathering Qì	宗氣	Air Qì + Gǔ Qì	Chest (stored)	Nourishes Heart & Lung; controls speech & voice strength; promotes blood circ. to extremities; works with Yuán Qì to regulate breathing
Source / Original Qì	原氣	Kidney Essence (Pre-Heaven)	Míng Mén; San Jiao	"Motive Force" — arouses & moves all organs; Zōng Qì → Zhēn Qì; conduit for San Jiao; exits at Source Points
True / Vital Qì	真氣	Zōng Qì (final stage)	Meridians	Final transformation; splits into Yíng Qì & Wèi Qì; this IS Meridian Qì
Nutritive Qì	營氣	Zhēn Qì (Yīn aspect)	Inside vessels & channels	Nourishes internal organs; closely linked to Blood; the Qì activated during acupuncture needling
Defensive Qì	衛氣	Zhēn Qì (Yáng aspect)	Outside vessels; Còu Lǐ 腠理	Protects from pathogens; controls pores; moistens skin & hair; warms Zang Fu; circulates 50×/24h (25× day, 25× night) . Linked to Lungs.
Central Qì	中氣	Spleen Qì	Middle Jiao	Supports SP transformation & transportation; raises Qì (prevents prolapse)
Upright Qì	正氣	Wèi Qì + Yíng Qì + Kidney Essence	Whole body	Body's total defense; opposite of Xié Qì 邪氣 (pathogenic Qì)
6 Functions of Qì				
Function	Mechanism		Clinical Note	
① Transporting	Movement = Life. Directions: upward, downward (ascending/descending), inward, outward (entering/exiting)		No movement = pain. Qì transports substances in and out of all body structures.	
② Warming	Function of Yáng Qì. All physiological processes depend on warmth.		Fluids are Yīn — they need Yáng warmth to transform, transport & excrete. Qì def → Cold signs.	
③ Protecting	Primarily Wèi Qì. Nourishes Còu Lǐ (exterior energetic layer). Linked to Lungs (govern skin).		Wèi Qì strength determines resistance to Wind, Cold, Dampness. Def → recurrent infections.	
④ Holding	Yáng Qì holds Yīn substances (Blood, fluids) in their proper places.		Deficiency → incontinence, excessive bleeding, sweating — fluids/blood "leak out."	
⑤ Transforming	Converts dense matter (food, fluids) into subtle Qì forms: Jīn (clear/Yáng) and Yè (turbid/Yīn).		Food → Gǔ Qì → Zhēn Qì. Qì def → Phlegm & Dampness accumulation.	
⑥ Rising	Holds body structures in proper anatomical position. Primary organ: Spleen (Zhōng Qì).		Qì def → sinking → organ prolapse (uterus, rectum, stomach). Different from Holding (anti-leak).	

Qì Pathologies — 4 Patterns			
Pattern	Mechanism & Cause	Signs & Symptoms	Tongue / Pulse
Qì Deficiency	More Qì consumed than produced. Affects Lung, Spleen, Kidney, Heart. Causes: illness, overwork, poor diet, lack of sleep, excessive sport	Fatigue (key symptom), slight SOB, weak voice, spontaneous sweating, poor appetite, loose stools, tiredness — physical & mental	Empty pulse; pale/normal tongue
Sinking Qì	Aspect of Qì Deficiency — insufficient Yáng Qì to rise & ascend. Primary organ: Spleen	All Qì Def signs PLUS: feeling of bearing down, mental depression, listlessness, organ prolapse (uterus, rectum)	Empty pulse
Qì Stagnation	Often Liver, also Lungs, Heart, Stomach, Spleen, Intestines. Causes: emotional stress, irregular eating, excessive work	Distension (subjective & objective), moving/distending pain (more distension than pain), mental depression, irritability, "gloomy," frequent sighing, mood swings	Wiry pulse; tongue normal or slightly red on sides
Rebellious Qì	Qì moves in wrong direction (Maciocia Table 31.1)	Stomach↑ → belching/nausea/vomiting; Spleen↑ → diarrhea/prolapse; Lung↑ → cough/asthma; Heart↑ → restlessness/insomnia; Kidney↑ → asthma; Liver varies → headache, nausea, burning urination	Varies by organ

Foods — Qì Deficiency

Almonds

Beef

Carrots

Cherry

Chicken

Coconut

Date

Eel

Egg

Fig

Garbanzo Beans

Goose

Grape

Ham

Lentil

Longan

Mackerel

Millet

Mushroom

Oat

Potato

Quinoa

Rabbit

Rice

Sardine

Squash

Sweet Potato

Tempeh

Tofu

Trout

Foods — Qì Stagnation

Basil

Cardamom

Carrot

Chive

Cloves

Fennel

Garlic

Mustard greens

Peach

Peppermint

Radish

Squash

Turmeric

Turnip

Vinegar

Xuè 血 / Blood

Key Concept — Different from Western Medicine

Blood in EAM is a very dense, material form of Qì — the most Yīn vital substance. *Sū Wèn* 26: "Blood is the mind of a person." *Líng Shū* 32: "When Blood is harmonized, the mind is calm in its residence." Men tend to be more ruled by Qì; women by Blood.

Sources of Blood		5 Functions of Blood	
Organ	Role	#	Function
Spleen	Main source — generates Blood from Gǔ Qì	1	Nourishes all tissues & organs
Lung	Pushes Gǔ Qì to the Heart for transformation	2	Circulates with Yíng Qì (inseparable)
Heart	Transforms Gǔ Qì into Blood	3	Moistens body, skin, sinews, eyes
Kidney	Makes Blood via Marrow & Kidney Essence	4	Houses the Shén — anchors Mind; Blood def → insomnia, anxiety
		5	Determines Menstruation (Tiān Guǐ)

Blood Pathologies — 4 Patterns			
Pattern	Mechanism	Signs & Symptoms	Tongue / Pulse
Blood Deficiency	Fails to nourish/moisten; fails to anchor Shén. Causes: inadequate blood-rich foods; deficiency in blood-producing organs; blood loss; consumed by mental/ physical activity	Dull-white sallow complexion; pale lips; dizziness; poor memory; numbness/tingling; blurred vision; insomnia; scanty periods/amenorrhoea; depression; slight anxiety	Pale, thin, slightly dry tongue; Choppy or Fine pulse
Blood Stasis	Potentially serious — linked to cancer, fibroids, endometriosis, heart disease, stroke. Causes: Qì stagnation; Qì def; Heat in Blood; Blood def; Interior Cold; Emotions; Diet; Trauma	Stabbing, fixed or boring pain; dark complexion; purple lips & nails; dark blood with dark clots; fixed abdominal masses	Purple tongue (location varies); Wiry, Choppy, or Firm pulse
Heat in Blood	Invasion of Heat to Yīn/Blood level OR excess internal heat in Liver/Heart	Feeling of heat; skin diseases with red eruptions; thirst; bleeding. Heart → anxiety, mouth ulcers; Liver → skin itching/redness; Uterus → excessive blood loss; Intestines → blood in stools	Red tongue; Rapid pulse
Loss of Blood	Cause 1: Qì Def → cannot hold Blood. Cause 2: Blood Heat → pushes Blood out. Less common: Blood Stasis; Yīn deficiency	Bloody nose, vomiting blood, blood in stool/urine, menorrhagia, metrorrhagia	Pale tongue; Fine/Choppy pulse

Qì Stagnation vs Blood Stasis — Key Differentiator (Maciocia Table 32.2)		
	Qì Stagnation	Blood Stasis
Pain vs distension	More <i>distension</i> than pain; moving	More <i>pain</i> than distension; fixed
Pain character	Distending, comes & goes	Boring or stabbing, constant
Abdominal masses	Appear and disappear	Fixed
Tongue	Normal or slightly red on sides	Purple on sides
Pulse	Wiry	Wiry, Firm, or Choppy

Blood Stasis — Signs by Location	
Location	Key Signs
Liver	Purple nails; dark face; painful periods with dark clots; abdominal & premenstrual pain; purple tongue on sides; wiry/firm pulse
Heart	Purple lips; stabbing/pricking chest pain; mental restlessness; purple tongue towards front; distended sub-lingual veins; choppy/knotted pulse
Lung (Upper Burner)	Chest oppression; coughing dark blood; tongue purple on sides towards front; distended sub-lingual veins
Stomach (Middle Burner)	Epigastric pain; vomiting dark blood; dark blood in stools; tongue purple in center
Intestines/Uterus (Lower Burner)	Dark blood in stools; severe abdominal pain; painful periods; dark menstrual blood with clots; amenorrhoea; fixed abdominal masses; wiry/firm pulse

Foods — Blood Deficiency



Foods — Blood Stagnation



What Can Cause Blood Stasis? (Slide 79 — 10 Causes)

Primary Causes

1. **Stagnation of Qi** — Qi moves Blood; if Qi stagnates, Blood stagnates
2. **Deficiency of Qi** — Qi holds and moves Blood; weakness → Blood sluggish
3. **Heat in the Blood** — Heat thickens and coagulates Blood
4. **Blood deficiency** — Less fluid → Blood thickens and stagnates
5. **Interior Cold** — Cold congeals and contracts Blood vessels
6. **Dampness & Phlegm** — Obstruct channels; impede Blood flow
7. **Trauma** — Directly damages vessels; Blood escapes and accumulates
8. **Emotions** — Emotional stagnation → Qi stagnation → Blood stasis
9. **Diet** — Excess fatty, sweet, or cold foods
10. **Lifestyle habits** — Overwork, sedentary behavior, excessive sex

Note: Trauma is NOT a cause but aggravates existing states (slide 79)

Organ-Specific Blood Stasis Presentations

- **Liver (slide 82):** Purple nails, dark face, painful periods with dark menstrual blood & dark clots, abdominal pain, premenstrual pain, purple tongue especially on the sides, Wiry or Firm pulse
- **Heart (slide 83):** Purple lips, stabbing/pricking chest pain, mental restlessness, purple tongue on the sides towards the front, purple & distended sub-lingual veins, Choppy or Knotted pulse
- **Lung/Upper Burner (slide 84):** Oppression of the chest, coughing dark blood, tongue purple on sides towards front, purple & distended sub-lingual veins
- **Stomach/Middle Burner (slide 85):** Epigastric pain, vomiting dark blood, dark blood in stools, tongue purple in the center with distended sub-lingual veins
- **Intestines & Uterus/Lower Burner (slide 86):** Dark blood in stools, severe abdominal pain, purple tongue at the rear; Uterus: painful periods, premenstrual pain, dark menstrual blood with dark clots, amenorrhea, fixed abdominal masses, purple tongue, Wiry or Firm pulse

Note on Vegetarianism (Slide 77 — Prof. Schrier)

Vegetarianism & Blood in EAM

Vegetarianism is fine and not an issue as long as managed well. China and India have the world's longest traditions of vegetarian diets due to the influence of Buddhism. It may become a cause of disease if one does not consume adequate Blood-nourishing foods (or herbs) to supplement the lack of meat. Support Blood by consuming blue/green algae, dark leafy greens, beets, etc. Support the foundation of Blood (Jing) by consuming nuts, seeds, beans, and eggs. **Avoid overly pungent foods** — these weaken the Blood by causing sweating and movement of Qi; also avoid foods that are hard to digest, which weaken the digestive system.

Jīn Yè 津液 / Body Fluids

津液

Originate from food & drink. Spleen separates clean from turbid → clean fluids to Lungs → skin → Kidneys. Turbid → Small Intestine → further separation → pure fluids up to Exterior (sweat); impure fluids down to Bladder → urine.

Jīn vs Yè — The Two Forms

	Jīn 津 (Yáng)	Yè 液 (Yīn)
Character	Clear, light, watery	Turbid, heavy, dense
Circulates with	Wèi Qì on Exterior (between skin & muscles)	Yíng Qì in Interior
Movement	Quick	Slow
Controlled by	Lung (Upper Burner)	Spleen & Kidneys (Middle & Lower Burner)
Moistens	Skin & muscles; manifests as sweat, tears, saliva, mucus; becomes part of Blood	Joints, spine, brain & bone marrow; lubricates orifices (eyes, ears, nose, mouth)

Organ Roles in Fluid Metabolism + Pathologies

Pattern / Organ	Mechanism	Signs & Symptoms
Small Intestine	Separates Body Fluids into pure & impure; provides Qì to Bladder	Key organ in fluid metabolism — "separating the clear from the turbid"
Triple Burner (San Jiao)	Assists transformation & excretion of fluids; conduit for Yuán Qì	The "decision-maker" of fluid pathways; Upper, Middle, Lower Burner roles
Bladder	Further transforms & separates received fluids	Pure → sweat (Exterior); Impure → urine (downward)
Fluid Deficiency	Yīn in nature → deficiency = dryness . Caused by: dietary factors, Yīn def, heavy blood loss, profuse sweating, vomiting, diarrhea	Lung → dry skin & cough; Stomach → dry tongue with horizontal cracks, dry mouth without desire to drink; Kidney → scanty urination, dry mouth at night; LI → dry stool
Edema — Pitting	Yáng deficiency of Spleen, Lungs, and/or Kidneys → cannot mobilize fluids	LU Yáng def → face & hands first; SP Yáng def → abdomen → four limbs; KD Yáng def → lower body, legs & ankles
Edema — Non-Pitting	Qì Stagnation or Dampness	No pit after pressing; swelling linked to emotions or damp accumulation

Phlegm (Tán) — All Types

Root Cause: Spleen Deficiency · "Spleen = source; Lungs = container"

Clinical markers: swollen tongue body, sticky coating, slippery or wiry pulse. Feeling of oppression in chest, nausea, heaviness, muzziness of head, dizziness.

Type	Category	Expectoration & Key Signs	Tongue	Pulse
Damp Phlegm	Substantial	Profuse sticky white; chest & epigastrium oppression; nausea; sticky taste; no thirst	Swollen, sticky coat	Slippery
Phlegm-Heat	Substantial	Sticky yellow; chest oppression; red face; dry mouth; restlessness	Red, swollen, sticky yellow coat	Rapid-Slippery
Cold Phlegm	Substantial	White, watery; chest oppression; cold limbs; nausea	Pale, swollen, white wet coat	Deep-Slippery-Slow
Wind Phlegm	Substantial	Coughing phlegm (often unilateral); dizziness; nausea; vomiting; numbness of limbs; rattling in throat; aphasia	Swollen, deviated, sticky coat	Wiry
Phlegm-Fluid	Substantial	Very thin, watery sputum; dizziness	Swollen, sticky coat	Wiry
Qì Phlegm <i>Méi Hé Qì 梅核氣 (Plum-Pit Qi)</i>	Non-substantial	No expectoration — feeling of swelling in throat (no actual swelling); difficulty swallowing; chest/diaphragm oppression; irritability; moodiness; depression	—	Wiry
Under Skin	Non-substantial	Lumps under skin; nerve ganglia swellings; lymph node swelling; thyroid swelling; lipomas	—	—
Misting Heart	Non-substantial	Mental illness; confusion; blocks Shén	—	—
In Channels	Non-substantial	Numbness of affected area	—	—
Gallbladder/Kidneys	Non-substantial	Stones (gallstones, kidney stones)	—	—
In Joints	Non-substantial	Bone deformities; chronic rheumatoid arthritis	—	—

Foods for Phlegm

Almonds

Apple Peel

Black Pepper

Daikon

Garlic

Mushroom

Mustard leaf/seed

Onions

Orange peel

Persimmon

Radish

Shiitake

Tea

Thyme

Shén 神 / Mind-Spirit

神

What is Shén? Functions: Consciousness · Thinking · Memory · Insight · Cognition · Sleep · Intelligence · Wisdom · Affections · Feelings · Senses

Most rarefied of the Three Treasures. Encompasses all Mental, Emotional, and Spiritual aspects — not just "spirit." Governed by Heart; reflected in brightness of eyes and clarity of speech and appropriateness of social behavior.

Observing the Shén — Clinical Table (Prof. Schrier)			
Observation	Having Shén (有神)	Loss of Shén (失神)	False Shén (假神)
Complexion	Bright and moist sheen	Dim and dull sheen	Dull with sudden flushed cheeks
Eyes	Alert, vivid, colors with a twinkle	Dull color with blurred vision	Dull colors but suddenly lustrous
Mind	Clear speech, consciousness, agile response	Unconscious, delirious	Unclear conscious with sudden change
Motion & Response	Free with quick response	Slow movement and response	Suddenly responsive
Respiration	Even	Rapid, feeble, or difficult	Feeble but then strong
Diet	Strong appetite	Poor	Poor but then improves

False Shén (Jiǎ Shén 假神) — CRITICAL: Terminal Sign

Sudden revival before death due to floating up of Yáng Qì. Yīn and Yáng separate. Causes: chronic disease exhausting Essence; high fever exhausting Yīn. A dying patient who suddenly seems dramatically better — this is NOT recovery. Do not be deceived.

Deranged Shén — 5 Types	
Type	Signs & Symptoms
Irritability & Restlessness Fán Zào 烦躁	Irritability, restlessness, hot and heavy sensation with feverish irritability; patient prefers nudity and may even jump into water
Visceral Agitation Zāng Zào 脏躁	Mental depression, hallucinations, disorientation, frequent attacks of melancholy and crying spells, bouts of yawning; no loss of consciousness
Lilly Disease Bǎi Hé Bìng 百合病	Chronic depression, apathy with aversion to speaking, mumbling to oneself, insomnia, anorexia, sleepwalking
Yīn Madness Diān 癡	Chronic depression, aversion to speaking or mumbling to oneself, laughing or crying inappropriately; sluggish, withdrawn
Yáng Madness Kuáng 狂	Raving with obscenities, madness and restlessness, singing loudly in high places, wandering naked, hitting people or destroying things

The Five Shén (Wǔ Shén 五神) — One Per Organ						
Shén	漢字	Organ	Quality & Nature	Responsible For	Imbalances	Key Point
Shén 神	神	Heart	Spirit of Inspiration, Insight, Awareness & Compassion. Most visible — allows clear thinking & social appropriateness.	Consciousness, thinking, affections, memory, sleep	Mania, lack of inspiration, scattered spirit, insomnia, hysteria, sadness, depression	BL-44 Mind Hall
Hún 魂	魂	Liver	Spirit of Vision, Imagination, Direction & Benevolence. Most like Western "soul" — enters at birth, leaves at death; repository of dreams, aspirations, ideals & inspiration.	Sleep, plans, projects, life aims	Delusions, hallucinations, psychosis, nightmares, sleepwalking, anger, frustration, jealousy, emotional swings, apathy, paranoia	BL-47 Gate of Ethereal Soul
Pò 魄	魄	Lung	Spirit of Animal wit, embodiment, sensation & appreciation. Associated with physical body — dies when body ceases. Allows instinctive reactions & bodily sensation.	Feelings and sensations	Emotionally numb, mind/body disconnect, lack of care for own well-being, over-indulgence, obsession with beauty, extreme vanity, sadness, grief, inability to let go	BL-42 Gate of Corporeal Soul
Yì 意	意	Spleen	Spirit of Integrity, Intention, Clear Thought & Devotion. Gives ability to think clearly & study; brings thoughts to fruition; power to persevere.	Thinking, memory, concentration	Lack of concentration, poor focus, overthinking, worrying, stuck thought processes, lack of sympathy, over-smothering	BL-49 Thought Shelter
Zhì 志	志	Kidney	Spirit of Instinctual power, aligned will, courage & wisdom. Embodies the drive to survive; will power and determination to be alive; motivates achievement in life.	Will power, determination, drive	Low willpower, lack of drive, no life goals, depression, fearfulness, low self-esteem	BL-52 Gate of Will Power

Relationships Between Vital Substances

Relationship	Detail & Clinical Implication
Qì commands Blood	Qì moves Blood (Qì stagnation → Blood stasis); Qì generates Blood; Qì holds Blood in vessels (Qì def → bleeding)
Blood is the mother of Qì	Blood nourishes the organs that produce Qì; Blood def → Qì def over time. Clinically treat both in chronic cases.
Blood nourishes Body Fluids	Mutually generative; Blood stasis or heavy bleeding → Body Fluid def
Body Fluids replenish Blood	Fluid def → Blood becomes thick and stagnant; profuse sweating/vomiting → Blood def
Qì transforms / transports / holds Body Fluids	Qì def → fluid accumulation → Phlegm/Dampness; Qì stagnation → fluid stagnation → edema
Body Fluids nourish Qì	Fluid def → Qì becomes unstable and floats
Liver Blood nourishes Essence	Liver Blood def over time → Kidney Essence def; clinically treat both together
Kidney Essence transforms into Blood	Jīng def → Blood def; marrow production → blood production link (treat Kidney to nourish Blood)

The Iron Rules: Qì commands Blood · Blood mothers Qì · Jīng and Blood share the same source (同源) · Fluids and Blood are mutually transforming

Clinical Applications of Relationships

- **Qì def → Blood def:** Chronic Qì deficiency fails to generate Blood → treat both with Qì and Blood tonics
- **Blood def → Qì def:** Blood def over time means Qì has no "mother" to nourish it → fatigue, weakness
- **Blood Stasis → Qì Stagnation:** Stagnant Blood obstructs Qì flow → always treat both
- **Qì Stagnation → Blood Stasis:** Over time, Qì failing to move Blood → Blood congeals. Key: *treat Qì first in early stages, both in chronic stages*
- **Heavy sweating → Blood def:** Profuse fluid loss (sweating, vomiting, diarrhea) → Body Fluid def → Blood becomes thick → Blood def

Liver Blood, Kidney Essence & Marrow (Slide 61)

- **Liver Blood nourishes Kidney Essence** — Liver stores Blood; this nourishes the Kidney Essence (Jīng). Called "Liver and Kidney sharing the same source" (肝腎同源 Gān Shèn Tóng Yuán)
- **Kidney Essence transforms into Blood** — Marrow produced by Kidney Essence can transform into Blood in the Heart
- **Clinical: treat Liver and Kidney together** when either Blood or Essence is deficient — they nourish each other
- **Heart rules Blood circulation** — moves and circulates Blood throughout the body
- **Spleen holds Blood in vessels** — ensures Blood stays in its proper channels; Spleen def → bleeding disorders

Eight Principles — Bā Gāng 八綱

八綱

Foundation for ALL other methods of pattern differentiation in TCM

System of differential diagnosis using four pairs of opposites (Yin/Yáng, Cold/Hot, Deficient/Excess, Interior/Exterior). Rooted in Sūwèn & Shāng Hán Lùn (Han dynasty); term coined Qīng dynasty (1644–1912), based on Zhāng Jīngyuè's Jīngyuè Quánshū — greatly simplified. **Critical rule: Interior vs Exterior is determined by the LOCATION of the disease — NOT by its etiology (cause).**

Interior 裡 ↕ Exterior 表	Full/Excess 實 ↕ Empty/Def 虛	Hot 熱 ↕ Cold 寒	Yang 陽 ↕ Yin 陰
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Memory: Yáng = Exterior + Full/Excess + Hot · Yīn = Interior + Empty/Deficient + Cold · Yīn-Yáng is the overarching umbrella organizing all other 6 principles.

Interior — Exterior (裡 — 表)

	Exterior (Biǎo 表)	Interior (Lǐ 裡)
Location	Skin, hair, muscles, interspaces, superficial meridians & collateral channels	Five Zang + Six Fu organs (trunk)
Duration	Short, acute onset	Chronic, longer duration ; mid-to-late stage
Fever/Chills	Fever WITH aversion to cold (both together)	Fever WITHOUT aversion to cold, OR aversion to cold without fever
Tongue coat	Thin white coating (superficial)	Yellow/black; slippery/greasy; body may be purplish/pale/trembling/deviated
Pulse	Floating	Deep , slippery, wiry, or choppy
Symptoms	Aversion to cold, "fever," aching body (especially upper), stiff neck, headache	Constipation, stomachache, heart palpitations, diarrhea — trunk & Zang-Fu
Sources of Interior	(1) Exterior pathogen penetrates inward; (2) Zang-Fu functional disturbance (no exterior stage needed); (3) Direct interior invasion — Stomach, Intestines, Uterus ("Do Not Pass Go")	

Exterior Patterns — Types & Clinical Signs

Pattern	Key Signs	Distinguishing Feature
Exterior Cold	Slight fever, pronounced aversion to cold, severe body aches, severe stiff neck, NO sweating, NO thirst	Floating-tight pulse; thin white coat. Cold contracts → tightens pulse & closes pores → no sweat.
Exterior Heat	Aversion to cold, fever, slight sweating, thirst	Floating-rapid pulse; tongue may be red on sides/front. Heat opens pores → sweating; heat → thirst.
Exterior Deficiency	Slight/no fever, sweating , aversion to wind, slight body aches	Floating-slow pulse; thin white coat. Wei Qi insufficient → pores cannot close → sweating.
Exterior Excess	Fever, NO sweating , severe body aches, aversion to cold	Floating-tight pulse; thin white coat. Pathogen strong enough to fully close pores.

Exterior Treatment Principles

- **Expel** the exogenous pathogen; keep evil from entering interior
- **Acupuncture**: Open meridians; expel pathogens. Points: head, arm, upper back (Yáng areas). Cupping on shoulder/upper back.
- **Herbs**: Light/leaf herbs float to exterior — Jīn Yín Huǒ, Bò Hé, Fáng Fēng, Xīn Yí Huǒ. "Lighter = works at surface" (law of signatures)

Interior Treatment Principles

- Set treatment by **real conditions** (interior cold, heat, def, excess)
- **Acupuncture**: Chest, back, leg, foot points; Mù points; Back-Shū points; Lower-He points; Source points
- **Herbs**: Roots, seeds — "heavy" medicinals that sink to the interior

Disease Transmission — Inward vs Outward Progression

Inward (worse): Aversion to cold disappears → feeling/aversion to heat begins. Caused by: weakened body resistance; hyperactivity of pathogens; improper/delayed treatment.

Outward (improvement): Pulse becomes less deep; tongue coat thins. Caused by: correct treatment, good care, strengthened resistance.

Exam Critical — The Two Major Symptoms of Exterior Patterns

Fever (Fā Rè 發熱) AND Aversion to Cold (Wù Hán 惡寒) occurring TOGETHER are the hallmark of an *exterior* pattern caused by invasion of an exogenous pathogenic factor. When you see BOTH fever and chills simultaneously, think Exterior. The key differentiator between the two exterior types:

- **Exterior Cold**: More aversion to cold than fever — pronounced chills, mild fever. Floating-Tight pulse. *No sweating, no thirst.*
- **Exterior Heat**: More fever than aversion to cold — prominent fever, mild chills. Floating-Rapid pulse. *Slight sweating, thirst.*

Interior patterns: Fever WITHOUT aversion to cold, OR aversion to cold WITHOUT fever (one excludes the other).

Hot vs Cold — Master Comparison

	Cold Pattern 寒 (Yīn)	Heat Pattern 熱 (Yáng)
Temperature pref.	Aversion to cold; preference for warmth	Aversion to heat; preference for coolness
Thirst	No thirst (or no desire to drink)	Yes — wants cold drinks
Face	Pale	Red
Limbs	Cold	Hot
Stools	Loose	Dry (constipation)
Urine	Clear, profuse (cold water is clear — "warm water with algae would be heat")	Scanty, dark yellow/red
Tongue	Pale body; white, moist/greasy coat	Red body; yellow, dry coat
Pulse	Slow or Tense	Rapid

Nature of Cold 寒 — Key Properties (Exam-Critical)

What Cold Does to the Body

- **Belongs to Yīn** — Cold is a Yīn pathogen that injures Yáng Qì
- **Causes Contraction** — Contracts the vessels, tendons, muscles, and pores (no sweating; tight muscles; stiff neck)
- **Causes Stagnation** — Impairs the free flow of Qì and Blood → pain that is worse with cold, better with warmth
- **Causes Blood to Congeal** — Slows and thickens the Blood → fixed, stabbing pain; cold vessels
- **Produces Clear Discharge** — All secretions are clear, watery, and profuse (clear urine, clear nasal discharge, loose watery stools)
- **Areas affected:** Exterior (short duration) OR Interior (long duration)

Nature of Heat 熱 — Key Properties

- **Belongs to Yáng** — Heat is a Yáng pathogen
- **Causes Redness** — Red face, red tongue, red eyes, red skin eruptions
- **Causes Rapid Pulse** — Heat accelerates circulation
- **Causes Bleeding** — Heat forces Blood out of vessels (epistaxis, haematuria, heavy periods) — *this is what Cold does NOT do*
- **Consumes Fluids** — Thirst; dry mouth; scanty dark urine; constipation
- **Produces Yellow/Red Discharge** — Yellow nasal mucus, dark urine, dry hard stools
- **Disturbs the Shén** — Irritability, restlessness, insomnia

Exam Trap — Cold vs Heat Properties: Cold *congeals* blood and causes *clear* discharge, *contraction*, and *stagnation*. Cold does **NOT** cause bleeding. Heat causes **bleeding**, redness, and yellow/red discharges. This was the basis of the "All of the following are true about Cold EXCEPT ____" question.

Full Heat vs Empty Heat (Maciocia Table 30.1)

	Full-Heat (Excess Yáng) 實熱	Empty-Heat (Yīn Def) 虛熱
Mechanism	External Yáng pathogen OR internally generated (emotional stress, diet) OR transformed from Cold	Yīn depleted → apparent Yáng excess. Main cause: overwork ("burning candle at both ends"). Also: irregular eating, excessive sexual activity, heavy blood loss.
Face	Whole face red	Malar flush only (cheekbones)
Thirst	Desire to drink cold water (large quantities)	Desire to drink in small sips only
Timing of heat	All day	Afternoon or evening only
Fever	High fever	Low-grade fever in afternoon
Hallmarks	Thirst, restlessness, red face, dry stools, scanty dark urine, constipation, profuse bleeding	Night sweats · Heat in 5 palms · Insomnia · Dry mouth at night · Dry throat at night
Tongue	Red with yellow coating	Red and Peeled (no coating)
Pulse	Full-Rapid-Overflowing	Floating-Empty-Rapid
Treatment	Clear Heat	Nourish Yīn; clear Empty-Heat

Full Cold vs Empty Cold (Maciocia Table 30.2)

	Full-Cold (Excess Yīn) 實寒	Empty-Cold (Yáng Def) 虛寒
Mechanism	Excess of Yīn — external Yīn pathogen (Wind-Cold, Cold-Damp); or direct interior invasion (Stomach/Intestines/Uterus); or internally generated Dampness/Phlegm	Yáng energy spontaneously deficient → apparent Yīn excess. Causes: excess cold foods, overwork, excessive sexual activity, Full-Cold.
Face	Bright-white	Dull-white
Pain	Sharp, worse on pressure	Dull, better on pressure
Bowels	Better after bowel movement	Worse after bowel movement
Key signs	Cold limbs, no thirst, pale face, abdominal pain aggravated by pressure, desire warm liquids, loose stools, clear abundant urination	Feeling cold, desiring warmth, cold limbs, pale urine, fatigue, weakness, pain improves with heat & pressure
Tongue / Pulse	Pale; thick white coat · Full-Tight-Deep pulse	Pale; thin white coat · Weak-Slow-Deep pulse

False Heat – True Cold & False Cold – True Heat (Maciocia Table 30.3)

Critical Distinction: False Heat/Cold ≠ Empty-Heat/Empty-Cold

In False Heat/Cold the **appearance is false** — there is **NO actual Heat or Cold**. Empty-Heat and Empty-Cold arise from Yīn or Yáng deficiency but there IS nevertheless real (albeit relative) Heat or Cold.

Diagnostic Sign	True Cold – False Heat	True Heat – False Cold
By observation	Red cheeks but red is like powder; rest of face white; irritability but listlessness; desire to lie with body curled up; pale and wet tongue	Dark face; bright eyes with "spirit"; red-dry lips; irritability; strong body; tongue body Red-dry
By hearing	Breathing quiet; low voice	Breathing noisy; loud voice
By interrogation	Thirst but no desire to drink warm; body feels hot but likes to be covered; sore throat without redness or swelling; pale urine	Thirst with desire to drink cold fluids; scanty dark urine; constipation; burning sensation in anus
By palpation	Pulse Rapid, Floating and Big but Empty	Pulse Deep, Full; cold limbs but chest is hot

Combined Hot & Cold Patterns

Pattern	Mechanism	Signs & Symptoms
Cold Exterior, Heat Interior	Has interior Heat; invaded by exterior Wind-Cold	Fever + aversion to cold + no sweating + headache + stiff neck + aches (Exterior Cold) WITH irritability + thirst (Interior Heat)
Heat Exterior, Cold Interior	Has Cold condition; attacked by exterior Wind-Heat	Fever + aversion to cold + headache + rapid pulse + sore throat (Exterior Heat) WITH loose stools + pale urine + chilliness (Interior Cold)
Heat Above, Cold Below	Heat rises; Cold descends	Above: thirst, irritability, sour regurgitation, bitter taste, mouth ulcers · Below: loose stools, borborygmi, profuse pale urine
Combination of Hot & Cold	Both coexist — very common in practice	E.g. Kidney-Yáng def + Bladder Damp-Heat; Spleen-Yáng def + Liver-Fire
False Heat–True Cold; False Cold–True Heat	Appearance deceptive	See Table 30.3 above for differentiation by observation, hearing, interrogation, palpation

Full / Excess — Empty / Deficient (實 — 虛)

實虛

Core Concept — Relative Strength of Pathogens vs Righteous Qì (Zhèng Qì)

Full = presence of a pathogenic factor (NOT excess of Zhèng Qì). **Empty** = deficiency of Zhèng Qì (includes Qì, Blood, Yīn, Yáng deficiency). One of the most important TCM concepts due to the emphasis on balance.

	Full / Excess (Shí 實)	Empty / Deficient (Xū 虛)
Definition	Pathogenic factor is PRESENT — not excess Zhèng Qì	Deficiency of Zhèng Qì — includes Qì, Blood, Yīn, Yáng deficiency
Manifestations	Symptoms relatively severe & intense ; restlessness; irritability; strong voice; coarse breathing; pain aggravated by pressure; high-pitched tinnitus; scanty urination; constipation	Manifestations much milder ; fatigue; soft/weak voice; slow movement; pain improves with pressure; low-pitched tinnitus; loose stools; frequent pale urination
Pain quality	Severe and intense; worse with pressure	More of an <i>ache</i> than a pain; better with pressure
Pulse	Full	Empty or Weak
Exterior variants	Fever; NO sweating; severe body aches; aversion to cold; floating-tight pulse; thin white coat	Slight/no fever; sweating; aversion to wind; floating-slow pulse; thin white coat

Interior Full & Empty — Heat/Cold Combinations

Pattern	Mechanism	Signs	Tongue / Pulse
Full Heat (Interior)	Excess Yáng; external or internal; emotional problems, diet (excess red meat/spices/alcohol), external pathogen transformed into Heat	Thirst (cold water), restlessness, headache, irritability, pain worse with pressure, red face, dry stools, scanty dark urine	Red tongue, yellow coat; Full-Rapid pulse
Full Cold (Interior)	Excess Yīn; external Yīn pathogen OR direct interior invasion OR internally generated Dampness/Phlegm	Cold limbs, no thirst, pale face, abdominal pain with pressure, desire for warm drinks, loose stools, clear abundant urination	Pale tongue, thick white coat; Deep-Full-Tight pulse
Empty Heat (Interior)	Yīn Deficiency → apparent Yáng excess. Main cause: overwork. Also: irregular eating, excessive sexual activity, heavy blood loss.	Night sweats, heat in 5 palms, dry mouth (small sips), afternoon/evening fever, insomnia, dry skin/eyes/throat at night	Red, Peeled tongue (no coat); Floating-Empty-Rapid pulse
Empty Cold (Interior)	Yáng Deficiency → apparent Yīn excess. Causes: dietary factors (excess cold foods), excessive physical work, overwork, Full-Cold	Feeling cold, cold limbs, pale face, fatigue, weakness, loose stools, frequent pale urination, pain improves with heat & pressure	Pale tongue, thin white coat; Deep-Slow-Weak pulse

Yīn — Yáng (陰 — 陽) Overarching Principles



Pattern	Also Known As	Mechanism	Key Symptoms	Tongue / Pulse
Excess of Yáng	Full Heat / Excess Heat	Excess Heat consumes Body Fluids. 3 types: (1) external Yáng pathogen (Wind-Heat, Summer-Heat); (2) internally generated (Heart-Fire, Liver-Fire from stress/diet); (3) transformed from other pathogens (even Cold → Interior Heat)	Restlessness, headache, irritability, pain worse with pressure	Red tongue, full pulse
Excess of Yīn	Full Cold / Excess Cold	Excess Cold consumes Yáng. External Yīn pathogenic factor (Wind-Cold, Cold-Damp) OR direct interior invasion (Stomach, Intestines, Uterus) OR internally generated Dampness/Phlegm	Cold limbs, weakness, contracture, pain improved with heat	Pale tongue, slow pulse
Deficiency of Yáng	Deficiency Cold / Empty Cold	Yáng energy spontaneously deficient → apparent Yīn excess → deficiency of physiological heat (Yáng Qì). Causes: excess cold foods, overwork, excessive physical work, Full-Cold	Feeling cold, desiring warmth, cold limbs, pale urine, fatigue, weakness, pain improves with heat & pressure	Pale tongue; Slow, Weak pulse
Deficiency of Yīn	Deficiency Heat / Empty Heat	Yīn energy depleted → apparent Yáng excess; consumes body fluids, Essence & Blood. Main cause: overwork. Can be caused by Full-Heat.	Dryness (dry mouth in afternoon, dry skin, dry eyes) + night sweats, heat in 5 palms, insomnia, low-grade afternoon fever	Red, peeled tongue (no coat); Floating-Empty-Rapid pulse

Collapse of Yīn & Yáng — Emergency States

Collapse = Extreme, Severe, Sudden Emptiness → Complete Separation of Yīn & Yáng → Often Followed by Death

Collapse of Yáng	Collapse of Yīn
Chilliness; cold limbs; weak breathing; profuse sweating with oily sweat; no thirst; frequent profuse urination or incontinence; loose stools or incontinence Pulse: Minute-Deep Tongue: Pale-Wet-Swollen-Short	Abundant perspiration; skin hot to touch; hot limbs; dry mouth; desire to drink cold liquids in small sips; retention of urine; constipation Pulse: Floating-Empty-Rapid Tongue: Red-Peeled-Short-Dry

Quick Reference — Exam Cheat Sheet

Tongue & Pulse Correlations

PALE TONGUE Blood def, Yang def, Cold	THICK YELLOW COAT Full Heat / Interior Heat	FLOATING PULSE Exterior condition	WIRY PULSE Liver / Qi Stagnation / Pain
RED TONGUE Heat (full or empty)	WHITE MOIST COAT Cold / Dampness	DEEP PULSE Interior condition	SLIPPERY PULSE Phlegm / Damp / Pregnancy
PURPLE TONGUE Blood Stasis	STICKY/GREASY COAT Phlegm / Dampness	RAPID PULSE Heat	CHOPPY PULSE Blood Def / Blood Stasis
PEELED (NO COAT) Yin def / Empty Heat	THIN WHITE COAT Exterior pattern	SLOW / TENSE PULSE Cold	EMPTY / WEAK PULSE Qi or Blood Deficiency
SWOLLEN TONGUE BODY Phlegm / Dampness	HORIZONTAL CRACKS Stomach Yin def	TIGHT PULSE Cold / Pain (contracting)	KNOTTED PULSE Heart Blood Stasis
DEVIATED TONGUE Wind / Wind-Phlegm	SUB-LINGUAL VEINS DISTENDED Blood Stasis	FULL PULSE Excess condition	MINUTE-DEEP PULSE Collapse of Yang

A+ Exam Traps — Golden Rules

Rule	Detail
Interior vs Exterior = LOCATION not cause	An exterior pathogen causing interior organ symptoms = Interior pattern. The etiology doesn't determine the category.
Full ≠ excess Zhèng Qì	Full means a pathogenic factor is PRESENT. Empty means Zhèng Qì is DEFICIENT.
False Heat/Cold ≠ Empty Heat/Cold	False = appearance is deceptive, no actual Heat/Cold. Empty = real but relative Heat/Cold from Yīn/Yáng deficiency.
Pre-Heaven Essence = fixed	CANNOT be replenished. Only Post-Heaven Essence can top it up. You get one candle — preserve it.
Wèi Qì = 50×/24h	25× during day, 25× at night. Circulates OUTSIDE vessels in the Còu Lǐ. Linked to Lungs.
Yíng Qì = acupuncture Qì	The Qì activated during acupuncture needling. Circulates INSIDE vessels with Blood. Yīn aspect of Zhēn Qì.
Qì commands Blood; Blood mothers Qì	Qì moves, generates, holds Blood. Blood nourishes organs that produce Qì. Treat both in chronic cases.
Phlegm root = Spleen	Primary cause always. "Spleen is the source; Lungs are the container." Lungs & Kidneys also involved.
Sinking Qì = Spleen / organ prolapse	Aspect of Qì Deficiency. Primary organ: Spleen (Zhōng Qì). Clinical result: organ prolapse (uterus, rectum, stomach).
Empty Heat hallmarks	Night sweats + heat in 5 palms + low-grade afternoon/evening fever = Yīn deficiency / Empty Heat. NOT excess heat.
Pitting vs Non-Pitting edema	Pitting = Yáng deficiency (SP/LU/KD). Non-pitting = Qì stagnation or Dampness.
Blood Stasis = fixed stabbing pain	Qì Stagnation = moving, distending. Blood Stasis = fixed, stabbing/boring. Key clinical differentiator.
False Shén = terminal sign	Sudden dramatic improvement in dying patient = Yīn & Yáng separating. Do NOT mistake for recovery.
Zōng Qì → speech & voice	Stored in chest from Air + Gǔ Qì. Weak voice = Zōng Qì deficiency. Also governs breathing strength.
Yuán Qì exits at Source Points	Stored at Míng Mén; distributes via San Jiao; exits at Source Points (Yuán Xué 原穴). Tonifying source points = tonifying Yuán Qì.
Sū Wèn cycles: 7 ♀ / 8 ♂	Every multiple of 7 (female) or 8 (male) years marks a new Jīng-governed developmental phase. Key for constitutional assessment.